This book takes you on an in-depth tour of the ASP.NET Core framework. To benefit from the book, you should be familiar with C# or a similar object-oriented language. Basic familiarity with web concepts such as HTML and JavaScript will also be beneficial. You'll learn the following:

- How to build HTTP API applications using minimal APIs
- How to create page-based applications with Razor Pages
- Key ASP.NET Core concepts such as model-binding, validation, and routing
- How to generate HTML for web pages by using Razor syntax and Tag Helpers
- How to use features such as dependency injection, configuration, and logging as your applications grow more complex
- How to protect your application by using security best practices

Throughout the book we'll use a variety of examples to learn and explore concepts. The examples are generally small and self-contained so that we can focus on a single feature at a time.

I'll be using Visual Studio for most of the examples in this book, but you'll be able to follow along using your favorite editor or integrated development environment (IDE). Appendix A includes details on setting up your editor or IDE and installing the .NET 7 software development kit (SDK). Even though the examples in this book show Windows tools, everything you see can be achieved equally well on the Linux or Mac platform.

TIP You can install .NET 7 from https://dotnet.microsoft.com/download. Appendix A contains further details on configuring your development environment to work with ASP.NET Core and .NET 7.